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1 A (BLU)ARMOR TO BREAK BIKERS' COMMUNICATION BARRIERS

Remember chattering away with your travel companions while in a car? How would that ever be possible on a road trip while riding to a picturesque location on bikes during the holidays? Well, BluArmor has come up with an incredible solution to an age-old but ignored issue. Read on to figure out how to get yapping with your biker buddies on your next bike trip



BluArmor's C30 (left), and C30 attached to a helmet (right)

Be it a road trip from Mumbai to Goa or riding to Ladakh via NH1D, every biker gang has a dedicated list of accessories to make their riding experience more enjoyable. The Bengaluru based startup BluArmor has come up with a new device that offers car-like intelligence for two-wheeler riders to make road trips for every biking enthusiast more enjoyable.

Incorporated in 2017 by founder and CEO Sundararajan Krishnan PK, BluArmor has designed an intercom device called C30 that can be attached to motorcycle helmets to offer total connectivity to the rider's

phone and vehicle as well as other riders in the group, up to a distance of 1.2km, allowing a group of bikers to communicate with each other.

Launched in November 2022, after two years of development, the printed circuit board assembly of the C30 comprises two radios simultaneously operating in the same frequency band without interfering with each other. One radio connects to the rider's mobile phone while the second radio connects the rider to their group. The device supports a Bluetooth connection to the rider's phone. The firmware includes proprietary algorithms for

mesh intercom, noise suppression, audio mixing, over-the-air firmware updates, and speed based volume control.

BluArmor's RIDEGRID mesh intercom connects multiple devices (up to 20) at the same time over a mesh and offers long-range communication while coexisting with music and phone calls. Its universal Bluetooth intercom connection RIDELYNK allows two devices to connect over 50 metres, making it ideal for a rider and pillion connection. It can be used to connect to a non-BluArmor device as well. Both channels operate in the same frequency band.

Explaining the uniqueness of the product, PK adds, "The fact that it can simultaneously support all of these connections is what is unique about the device. The rider connects with their riding group through the mesh intercom and to the bike via a BLE connection that coexists with Bluetooth classic connection. Each of these aspects has a technology of its own, but what is unique is that you have it all on one device."

The C30 features a 1000mAh lithium-polymer battery and offers more than 16 hours of overall usage on a single charge. "The device takes about one hour to charge from 10 %